Project: Worked examples
Title: Duct sizing
Status: DRAFT · Author: TempestOS (2026-10-23) · Checker: — (—) · Issued: —

1. Scope and method

Sizes each duct section by the equal-friction method (a target friction rate) or the velocity method (a target velocity), rounds to standard sizes, and reports velocity, friction rate, friction and fitting losses per section and the total pressure drop along the index run, with warnings against user velocity and pressure-drop limits.

WHAT IT CALCULATES	RELATION
Round duct diameter from the design target	D by Colebrook with the air properties at T (equal friction), or D = √(4Q/πv) (velocity), rounded up to the next standard size
Rectangular duct of equal friction and capacity	D_e = 1.30 (ab)^0.625/(a + b)^0.25
Flat-oval duct of equal friction and capacity	D_e = 1.55 A^0.625/P^0.25, with A = πb²/4 + b(a − b) and P = πb + 2(a − b)
Friction loss per metre, at the velocity v_e of the equivalent round duct	Δp/L = f ρ v_e²/(2D_e)
Fitting losses, at the actual velocity	Δp = ΣC ρ v²/2
Index-run totals, summed over every section of the run	Δp_run = Σ(Δp/L · L + ΣC ρ v²/2)

Basis: Duct design (friction chart basis, equivalent diameters, loss coefficients)[1](Ch. 21); Flow of fluids in pipes and ducts[2](Section 4); Ventilation for buildings: sheet metal air ducts and fittings with rectangular cross-section, dimensions[3]; Ventilation for buildings: sheet metal air ducts and fittings with circular cross-section, dimensions[4].

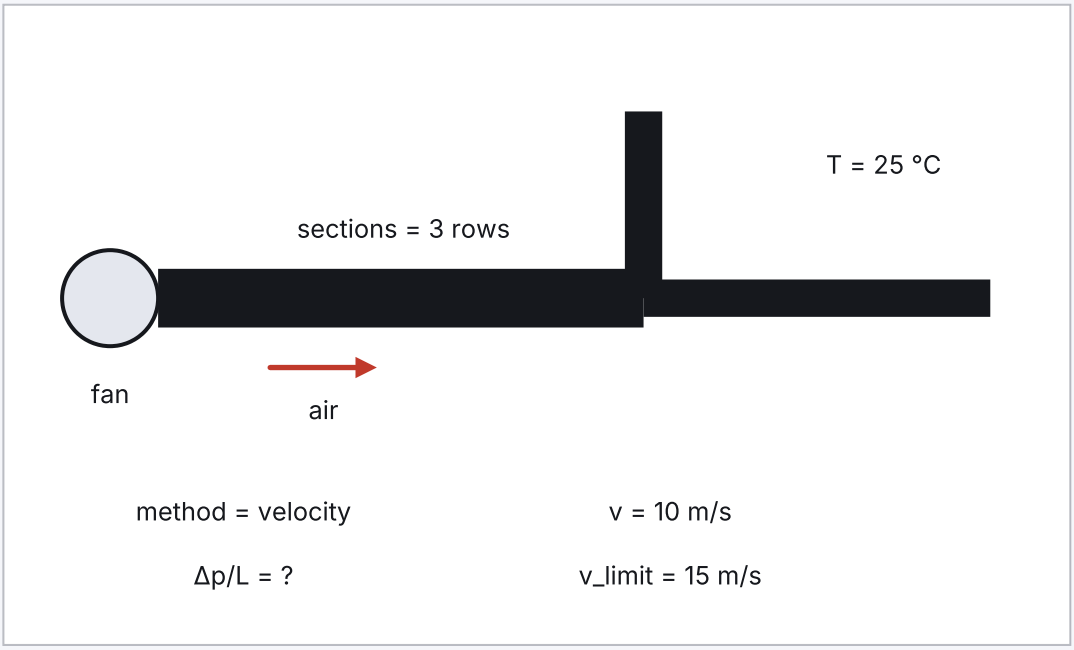


Figure 1 — A duct run from the fan through its sections as listed (a main and two branches drawn), each sized by the chosen method. Not to scale; the labels are the inputs as entered.

2. Inputs

SYMBOL	DESCRIPTION	VALUE	UNIT	SOURCE	VALID RANGE
method	Sizing method	velocity		assumption: Velocity method for an extract system.	any
dp_target	Target friction rate (equal friction)	1	Pa/m	default	0.3 … 5 Pa/m
v_target	Target velocity (velocity method)	10	m/s	spec: Dust-carrying extract: 10 m/s minimum transport velocity, SPEC-M-09	2 … 20 m/s
T	Air temperature	25	°C	assumption: Workshop air 25 °C.	-20 … 60 °C
p_atm	Barometric pressure	100.5	kPa	assumption: Site 70 m AOD, ≈ 100.5 kPa.	80 … 105 kPa
eps	Duct roughness	0.15	mm	assumption: Spiral-wound galvanised duct with joints.	0.03 … 3 mm
sections	Duct sections	3 row(s)		drawing: DRG-M-310 rev A	any
v_limit	Velocity limit (warning and check)	15	m/s	spec: SPEC-M-09 noise limit	2 … 30 m/s
dp_limit	Total pressure-drop limit (check)	600	Pa	spec: Extract fan external static 600 Pa	50 … 2000 Pa
round_to	Round sizes up to a multiple of	50	mm	spec: BS EN 1506 preferred sizes	1 … 100 mm

TABLE ROW	VALUES
sections[1]	name = hood branch; Q = 0.35 m^3/s; L = 6 m; shape = round; a = —; D = —; C = 1.5; dp_eq = 120 Pa; index = yes
sections[2]	name = main; Q = 1.05 m^3/s; L = 20 m; shape = round; a = —; D = —; C = 0.6; dp_eq = 0 Pa; index = yes
sections[3]	name = stack; Q = 1.05 m^3/s; L = 8 m; shape = round; a = —; D = —; C = 1; dp_eq = 30 Pa; index = yes

3. Assumptions

A1. Air is dry at the stated temperature and pressure (ρ = p/(287.055 T)); viscosity by Sutherland's law. (Standard air properties.)
A2. Rectangular and flat-oval ducts are sized through the equivalent diameter for equal friction and capacity. (Huebscher / Heyt–Diaz relations as given in ASHRAE Fundamentals Ch. 21.)
A3. Fitting loss coefficients C are user-supplied (manufacturer or ASHRAE/CIBSE data, not embedded) and refer to the section's velocity pressure. (Non-negotiable: no standard tables embedded.)
A4. method (Sizing method) is taken as velocity. (Velocity method for an extract system.)
A5. T (Air temperature) is taken as 25 degC. (Workshop air 25 °C.)
A6. p_atm (Barometric pressure) is taken as 100.5 kPa. (Site 70 m AOD, ≈ 100.5 kPa.)

A7. eps (Duct roughness) is taken as 0.15 mm. (Spiral-wound galvanised duct with joints.)

4. Working

[10] rho = p / (287.055 T)
= 100500 Pa / (287.055 × 298.15 K)
= 1.1743 kg/m³
Air density

[11] mu = Sutherland's law
= T = 298.15 K
= 18.371 uPa·s
Air dynamic viscosity

[12] D_s1 = hood branch: diameter
= target 211.1 mm rounded up to 50 mm
= 250 mm
Diameter, hood branch

[13] v_s1 = hood branch: Q / A
= 0.35 / 0.049087
= 7.1301 m/s
Velocity, hood branch

[14] Re_s1 = hood branch: ρ v_e D_e / μ (v_e = 4Q/πD_e²)
= 1.1743 × 7.1301 × 0.25 / 0.000018371
= 113940
Reynolds number, hood branch

[15] f_s1 = hood branch: friction factor
= Colebrook–White
= 0.02041
Friction factor, hood branch

[16] dpL_s1 = hood branch: f ρ v_e² / (2 D_e)
= 0.02041 × 1.1743 × 7.1301² / (2 × 0.25)
= 2.4369 Pa/m
Friction rate, hood branch

[17] dp_f_s1 = hood branch: (Δp/L) L
= 2.4369 × 6
= 14.622 Pa
Friction loss, hood branch

[18] dp_fit_s1 = hood branch: ΣC ρ v²/2
= 1.5 × 29.849
= 44.774 Pa
Fitting loss, hood branch

[19] dp_s1 = hood branch: friction + fittings + equipment
= 14.622 + 44.774 + 120
= 179.4 Pa
Section loss, hood branch (index run)

[20] D_s2 = main: diameter
= target 365.64 mm rounded up to 50 mm
= 400 mm
Diameter, main

[21] v_s2 = main: Q / A
= 1.05 / 0.12566
= 8.3556 m/s
Velocity, main

[22] Re_s2 = main: ρ v_e D_e / μ (v_e = 4Q/πD_e²)
= 1.1743 × 8.3556 × 0.4 / 0.000018371
= 213630
Reynolds number, main

[23] f_s2 = main: friction factor
= Colebrook–White
= 0.018028
Friction factor, main
[24] dpL_s2 = main: f ρ v_e² / (2 D_e)
= 0.018028 × 1.1743 × 8.3556² / (2 × 0.4)
= 1.8475 Pa/m
Friction rate, main
[25] dp_f_s2 = main: (Δp/L) L
= 1.8475 × 20
= 36.95 Pa
Friction loss, main
[26] dp_fit_s2 = main: ΣC ρ v²/2
= 0.6 × 40.992
= 24.595 Pa
Fitting loss, main
[27] dp_s2 = main: friction + fittings + equipment
= 36.95 + 24.595 + 0
= 61.545 Pa
Section loss, main (index run)
[28] D_s3 = stack: diameter
= target 365.64 mm rounded up to 50 mm
= 400 mm
Diameter, stack
[29] v_s3 = stack: Q / A
= 1.05 / 0.12566
= 8.3556 m/s
Velocity, stack
[30] Re_s3 = stack: ρ v_e D_e / μ (v_e = 4Q/πD_e²)
= 1.1743 × 8.3556 × 0.4 / 0.000018371
= 213630
Reynolds number, stack
[31] f_s3 = stack: friction factor
= Colebrook–White
= 0.018028
Friction factor, stack
[32] dpL_s3 = stack: f ρ v_e² / (2 D_e)
= 0.018028 × 1.1743 × 8.3556² / (2 × 0.4)
= 1.8475 Pa/m
Friction rate, stack
[33] dp_f_s3 = stack: (Δp/L) L
= 1.8475 × 8
= 14.78 Pa
Friction loss, stack
[34] dp_fit_s3 = stack: ΣC ρ v²/2
= 1 × 40.992
= 40.992 Pa
Fitting loss, stack
[35] dp_s3 = stack: friction + fittings + equipment
= 14.78 + 40.992 + 30
= 85.772 Pa
Section loss, stack (index run)

[36] dp_index = Σ section losses on the index run
= 3 section(s)
= 326.71 Pa
Index-run pressure drop
[37] dp_all = Σ section losses, all sections
= 3 section(s)
= 326.71 Pa
Sum over every section (not a path)
[38] v_peak = highest section velocity
=
= 8.3556 m/s
Highest velocity
[39] u_dp = dp_index / dp_limit
= 326.71 / 600
= 0.54452
Pressure-drop utilisation
[40] u_v = v_peak / v_limit
= 8.3556 / 15
= 0.55704
Velocity utilisation

5. Results

SYMBOL	VALUE	DESCRIPTION
D_s1	250 mm	D, hood branch
v_s1	7.1301 m/s	v, hood branch
Re_s1	113940	Re, hood branch
f_s1	0.02041	f, hood branch
dpL_s1	2.4369 Pa/m	Δp/L, hood branch
dp_f_s1	14.622 Pa	Friction loss, hood branch
dp_fit_s1	44.774 Pa	Fitting loss, hood branch
dp_s1	179.4 Pa	Section loss, hood branch
D_s2	400 mm	D, main
v_s2	8.3556 m/s	v, main
Re_s2	213630	Re, main
f_s2	0.018028	f, main
dpL_s2	1.8475 Pa/m	Δp/L, main
dp_f_s2	36.95 Pa	Friction loss, main
dp_fit_s2	24.595 Pa	Fitting loss, main
dp_s2	61.545 Pa	Section loss, main
D_s3	400 mm	D, stack
v_s3	8.3556 m/s	v, stack
Re_s3	213630	Re, stack
f_s3	0.018028	f, stack

SYMBOL	VALUE	DESCRIPTION
dpL_s3	1.8475 Pa/m	Δp/L, stack
dp_f_s3	14.78 Pa	Friction loss, stack
dp_fit_s3	40.992 Pa	Fitting loss, stack
dp_s3	85.772 Pa	Section loss, stack
dp_index	326.71 Pa	Index-run Δp
dp_all	326.71 Pa	Σ all sections
v_peak	8.3556 m/s	Highest velocity

6. Checks (governing first)

RESULT	CHECK	DEMAND	CAPACITY	UTILISATION	REF
PASS	Velocity ≤ limit	u_v = 0.55704	u_v ≤ 1	0.557	
PASS	Index-run Δp ≤ limit	u_dp = 0.54452	u_dp ≤ 1	0.545	

7. Applicability

WARNING — input.dp_target: dp_target (Target friction rate (equal friction)) was not entered; the template default 1 Pa/m is used.

8. Verification

Template bs.duct-sizing@1.0.1 Content hash 25b304ddb2f458ea Engine calc-engine/1.0.0
Known-answer cases passed 3/3 Test run 2026-10-23 12:00 UTC TempestOS 0.26.0

9. References

1. American Society of Heating, Refrigerating and Air-Conditioning Engineers. ASHRAE Handbook—Fundamentals. ASHRAE.
2. Chartered Institution of Building Services Engineers. CIBSE Guide C: Reference Data. CIBSE; 2007.
3. British Standards Institution. Ventilation for Buildings—Sheet Metal Air Ducts and Fittings With Rectangular Cross-Section—Dimensions. BS EN 1505. BSI.
4. British Standards Institution. Ventilation for Buildings—Sheet Metal Air Ducts and Fittings With Circular Cross-Section—Dimensions. BS EN 1506. BSI.